

Audit & Reporting Q&A Copilot

Every step, start to finish, including the current (2026) way to build the tool in Step 6 — an agent flow writing to a new SharePoint list and notifying via Teams.

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What You're Building

An agent that answers audit and journal questions with citations, and lets auditors formally flag control exceptions, grounded in one data file, acting through one governed tool.

AGENT NAME	Audit & Reporting Q&A Copilot
ORCHESTRATION	Generative (AI-led)
KNOWLEDGE	Finance_Audit_Data.xlsx
CUSTOM TOPIC	Investigate Control Exception
TOOL	Flag Journal for Audit Review (agent flow → SharePoint + Teams)

Files & Where They Go

FILE / ITEM	GOES TO	USED IN
Finance_Audit_Data.xlsx	Copilot Studio → Knowledge tab → Add knowledge → File	Step 3
AuditFindings_SharePointList_Template.xlsx	SharePoint site → New → List → From Excel	Step 6
AuditFindingRaised_AdaptiveCard.json	Paste into the flow's Adaptive Card field	Step 6

Before you start — confirm Environment Maker permission, and Contribute access on the SharePoint site that will host the Audit Findings list.

Set Up the Agent

Steps 1–3 — create the agent shell, pick how it reasons, and ground it in data.

1 Create Your Copilot Studio Agent

Open Copilot Studio (copilotstudio.microsoft.com), select **Create** → **New agent**, then configure:

AGENT NAME	Audit & Reporting Q&A Copilot
DESCRIPTION	Answers questions on month-end actuals, journal variances, control exceptions, and audit trail for cost-centre owners and internal auditors.
SOLUTION / ENVIRONMENT	Finance Solution · Default environment
ICON	Use a recognisable colour and emoji or upload a brand icon

2 Choose Orchestration Mode

Under **Settings** → **Generative AI**, use **Generative Orchestration** (AI-led) so the agent can blend knowledge lookups with tool calls for audit, journal review and control exceptions.

3 Add Knowledge

Knowledge tab → **Add knowledge** → **File** → upload **Finance_Audit_Data.xlsx**. Contains:

- Journal data (journal ID, period, cost centre, account, description)
- Amounts (debit USD, credit USD, net USD)
- Control signals (control flag — Pass / Review / Fail, variance vs budget %)
- Audit trail (approver, posted date)

You can layer additional sources later — SharePoint sites, Dataverse, public web, or Graph connectors.

Behavior: Instructions & Topic

Steps 4–5 — tell the agent how to behave, then give it a reusable conversation flow.

4 Add Agent Instructions

Overview → Instructions — paste exactly:

You are the Audit & Reporting Q&A Copilot. You help two audiences:

- 1) Cost centre owners reviewing their journals.
- 2) Internal auditors reviewing the control exceptions queue.

Rules:

- Use the uploaded journal dataset as your single source of truth.
- Always cite the JournalID for every number you quote.
- Never invent or round numbers – quote them as recorded.
- Flag rows with ControlFlag = Fail at the top of any answer.
- For actions (flag a journal for review), call the tool – do not just say it is flagged.
- Owners only see their own cost centre rows; auditors see everything.

5 Add a Custom Topic

Topics → Add a topic → Create from description:

Topic name: Investigate Control Exception

Description: Walks an auditor through the rows currently flagged Fail or Review, explains the control rule that fired, and offers to formally raise the exception for follow-up.

Trigger phrases:

- Show me control exceptions for this period
- What journals failed control
- Investigate the Fail rows
- Walk me through control issues

Conversation steps:

- Ask for the period (default: most recent in data)
- Filter ControlFlag in (Fail, Review), order by absolute NetUSD desc
- For each row, cite JournalID, CostCentre, Account, NetUSD, VarianceVsBudgetPct
- Explain the likely control rule that fired (e.g. variance > 10%)
- Ask which JournalID to formally flag – if any
- Call 'Flag Journal for Audit Review' with the chosen JournalID and reason

Build the Tool (Current Method)

Step 6 — updated for 2026, using current Copilot Studio tool-building.

6a Create the SharePoint List First

SharePoint site → **New** → **List** → **From Excel** → upload **AuditFindings_SharePointList_Template.xlsx** → name it **Audit Findings**. Set **FindingCategory**, **SuggestedAction**, and **Status** to SharePoint **Choice** columns after import to match their Excel dropdowns.

6b Build the Agent Flow

1. **Flows** → **New flow** → **Agent flow**.
2. Trigger inputs: **JournalID**, **Period**, **FindingCategory**, **AuditorNote**, **SuggestedAction**.
3. Action: **SharePoint** — **Create item** → list **Audit Findings** → map the fields.
4. Action: **Teams** — **Post your own adaptive card as the Flow bot to a user/channel** → the cost-centre owner and the internal audit lead → paste the contents of **AuditFindingRaised_AdaptiveCard.json** into the Adaptive Card field, then replace each `{Placeholder}` with the matching field from Dynamic content.
5. **Respond to the agent** → output **FindingID** from the SharePoint item's ID. Confirm **Asynchronous response = Off**.
6. **Publish** the flow.

6c Attach It as a Tool

1. **Tools** → **Add a tool** → filter by **Flow** → select it → **Add and configure**.
2. **Name**: Flag Journal for Audit Review. **Description**: "Files a formal audit finding against a journal row and notifies the owner and audit lead."
3. Under **Completion**, respond using the returned **FindingID**.
4. **Save**.

Original spec, for reference — Tool: Flag Journal for Audit Review. Type: Power Automate flow → SharePoint list 'Audit Findings' + Teams adaptive card. Files a formal audit finding against a specific journal row, notifies the cost-centre owner and the internal audit lead. Inputs: Journal ID (string, from knowledge); Period (string, e.g. '2026-04'); Finding category (Variance / Control / Documentation / Other); Auditor note (string); Suggested action (Reclass / Reverse / Document / No action). Outcome: Returns the audit finding ID and posts an adaptive card to the cost-centre owner and the internal audit lead.

Configure, Evaluate, Test, Publish

Steps 7–10 — lock down settings, prove quality, and ship it.

7 Configure Settings

Settings cog (top right) — four areas before real users touch the agent:

- **General** — confirm name, description, primary language
- **Generative AI** — orchestration mode, content moderation (start at Medium)
- **Authentication** — "Authenticate with Microsoft" so the agent runs as the signed-in user
- **Security** — review DLP policy, enabled channels, end-user authentication

8 Evaluate Your Agent

Analytics → **Evaluations** → **New evaluation** — "Audit & Reporting Copilot — Baseline v1". Score every response on Groundedness, Relevance, Accuracy.

Input: Show all journals with ControlFlag = Fail in period 2026-04

Expect: Returns rows filtered by Period and ControlFlag=Fail, cites JournalIDs.

Input: Which cost centres had a variance over 10% vs budget?

Expect: Returns rows where VarianceVsBudgetPct > 10, ordered desc, with NetUSD cited.

Input: Flag journal J-2271 for audit review – undocumented vendor accrual

Expect: Triggers the Investigate Control Exception topic and calls Flag Journal for Audit Review.

9 Test in the Test Pane

For each query, open **Activity map** to see: which topic/tool/knowledge fired, the inputs collected and outputs returned, citations to source rows, and per-step latency.

10 Publish to a Channel

Recommended for this build: Microsoft Teams (Finance Controls channel) and M365 Copilot. Pin the agent in the **Finance Controls** Teams channel for auditors; surface it in **Microsoft 365 Copilot** for cost centre owners reviewing their own journals; embed on the Finance intranet 'audit corner' page; or link the agent from the period close Power BI dashboard. Teams and M365 Copilot channels require tenant admin approval.

Try These Live

Sample queries to run once the agent is built — and what it replaces.

Control Exceptions

- Show all journals flagged Fail in the current period.
- Which cost centres have the most Review flags this period?

Variance Lookups

- What is the largest debit posted to cost centre CC-440 this period?
- Show journals with variance > 10% vs budget, biggest absolute value first.

Governed Action

- Flag journal J-2271 for review — auditor note 'evidence missing'.
- Try a paraphrase: 'this entry looks off, raise it with audit'.

This agent replaces

- Manual pivots over the GL extract
- Email chains to chase exception explanations
- Audit findings logged in unstructured spreadsheets

With

- Citations linking every number to a JournalID
- Structured audit findings flowing into SharePoint
- Faster close, with control exceptions surfaced first

Tip for real-world use — bind the agent to your authenticated identity via Entra so a cost-centre owner only sees their own rows automatically. Run the evaluation set after every period close.